Module 1
Introduction to Seeing Through Photographs

- Welcome to Seeing Through Photographs! — Reading • 3 min
- Getting Started: How Does This Course Work? — Reading • 6 min
- Seeing Through Photographs Course Trailer — Video • 1 min
- Sarah Meister Introduces the Course — Video • 2 min
- Marvin Heiferman on "Photography Changes Everything" — Video • 3 min
- Optional Discussion Forum Prompts — Reading • 10 min
- Optional Readings and Resources — Reading • 10 min

Module 2
One Subject, Many Perspectives

Part I: Introduction

- Introduction to Module 1 — Reading • 2 min
- Artistic Equivalents — Reading • 2 min
- Vik Muniz on Photographing the Familiar — Video • 3 min

Part II: Telescopes and Cameras

- Introduction to Part II: Surface, Scale, and Technology — Video • 2 min
- Practical Scenario — Real-world application • 5 min
- **Moons and Surfaces** — Reading • 5 min
- Hear More: Sarah Meister on Eugène Atget. Pendant l'éclipse. 1912 — Video • 3 min
- Hear More: Liz Deschenes on Tilt/Swing (360° field of vision, version 1), 2009 — Video • 1 min
- Surface, Scale, Technology — Dialogue • 15 min

Part III: Seeing the Unseen

- Introduction to Part III: Man on the Moon — Video • 2 min
- Photographs by NASA — Reading • 2 min
- Hear More: Sarah Meister on U.S.G.S. and NASA, Surveyor III. Surface of the Moon, Day 319, W-F. 1967 — Video • 1 min
- Practical Scenario — Real-world application • 5 min
- Who Does the Moon Belong To? — Reading • 4 min

Part IV: It's Only a Paper Moon

- Introduction to Part IV: Vernacular and Fine Art Photographs of the Moon — Video • 3 min
- Moon Phases — Reading • 6 min
- Hear More: Sarah Meister on Ansel Adams. Moonrise, Hernandez, New Mexico. 1941 — Video • 3 min
- Man on the Moon and Paper Moons — Dialogue • 15 min

Part V: Review and Respond

- Optional Readings and Resources — Reading • 10 min
- Practice Memory Check — Practice Assignment • 30 min
- Optional Discussion Prompts and Creative Challenges — Reading • 10 min

Module 3
Documents and the Documentary

Module 4
One and Another

Module 5
Constructing Narratives, Challenging Histories

Module 6
Pictures of People

Module 7
Ocean of Images

Moons and Surfaces

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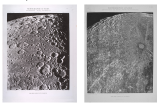
John Adams Whipple



John Adams Whipple. *The Moon*. 1853–54. Salted paper print, 7 1/4 × 6" (18.4 × 15.2 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Gift of Warner Communications, Inc.

Pairing the camera with the telescope, John Adams Whipple was an early practitioner of astronomical and night photography. Between 1847 and 1852, he and Harvard astronomer William Cranch Bond used the university's Great Refractor Telescope—the world's largest at the time—to produce award-winning photographs of the moon that are remarkable for their close perspective, clarity of detail, and sheer beauty. To make this print, Whipple first used the daguerreotype process to capture an image of the moon, which involved exposing a metal plate coated in light-sensitive chemicals. Because daguerreotypes were usually very small, he then copied the image onto a glass plate negative, which became the basis for his salted paper print.

Maurice Loewy and Pierre Henri Puiseux



Maurice Loewy and Pierre Henri Puiseux. Left: *The Moon (Boussingault, Vlacq, Maurolycus, Puiseux)*; right: *The Moon (Radiance of Tycho, Waning Phase)*. 1899/1900. Photogravures, each 22 1/2 × 18 1/4" (57.3 × 46.4 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Purchase

French astronomers Maurice Loewy and Pierre Henri Puiseux set out to create a comprehensive and detailed map of the moon. Published in 1903, *Atlas photographique de la lune* contains thousands of illustrations of the moon, each one produced as a photogravure. To make a photogravure, photographers transferred the image from a negative onto an etching plate that could then produce thousands of prints.

Eugène Atget



Eugène Atget. *During the Eclipse (Pendant l'éclipse)*. 1912. Gelatin silver printing-out-paper print, 6 7/16 × 8 5/8" (16.3 × 21.9 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Abbott-Levy Collection. Partial gift of Shirley C. Burden

Although the moon is not visible in this photograph by Eugène Atget, its presence is implied. This crowd was gathered in Paris's Place de la Bastille on April 17, 1912 to observe a solar eclipse (where the moon comes directly between the earth and sun) through viewing apparatuses. Rather than recording the astronomical event itself, Atget turned his attention to its spectators. Though Atget made nearly 10,000 pictures of Paris and its environs in a career that spanned over thirty years—most documenting the built environment—this photograph is an unusual example that focuses on a crowd of people.

Liz Deschenes



Liz Deschenes. *Tilt/Swing (360° field of vision, version 1)*. 2009. Six unique silver-toned black-and-white photograms, 136 × 192 × 58" (345.4 × 487.7 × 147.3 cm); installation (room): 206 × 192 × 216" (523.2 × 487.7 × 548.6 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Purchase. © 2020 Liz Deschenes

Deschenes's work explores the relationships between the mechanics of seeing, the image-making processes, and modes of display. To create *Tilt/Swing (360° field of vision, version 1)*, she exposed photosensitive paper to the light from the moon, stars, and surrounding buildings. The resulting photograms (photographic images made without using a camera) propose a new way of capturing the moon as well as our fascination with it. Their reflective surfaces not only serve as mirrors in which viewers can see themselves, but also accumulate traces of their surroundings as the surfaces oxidize in response to shifts in light and other conditions. In this way, the work retains an ever-growing memory of the situations in which it is exhibited, challenging the notion that a photograph represents a single moment that has passed.

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